multipolar discourse in world affairs is essential, as Russia is unhappy with the Western hegemonic domination. Noted Russian scholar Alexander Dugin (2014) stated that IR was regarded as an Anglo-American social science for a long time. However, since the recent past, the discipline of IR drifted toward China, India, Africa, and elsewhere for non-Western perspectives on IR and IR theory.

Most IR theorists paid little attention to the Russian perspective on international relations and its practice. The concept of multipolarity in international relations was first used by the Russian scholar Nikolay Danileskey more than a hundred years ago. However, it was not taken seriously. But, most of the current IR theorists follow Samuel Huntington's thesis about the plurality of civilization. While Western scholars talk about nation-states, Russian scholars assert civilizations in multipolarity. Furthermore, nation-states are similar, but civilizations are multiple and more subjective. There is a vast gap between Western multipolarity and Russian–Chinese multipolarity (Titarenko and Petrovsky 2015). The concept of multipolarity is not in global integration but regional integration. According to changes occurring in current world politics, all major powers like Russia, China, India, SCO countries, and some other developing countries believe that the current world order is unbalanced and needs reformation. Therefore, it is necessary to place multipolarity as a new trend in world politics (ibid.). Nonetheless, Russia and China were the first countries that promoted multipolar strategies in world affairs.

Russian Multipolarity

The conceptualization of multipolarity in Russia was done around 1993 (Ambrosio 2007). After the Soviet Union event, the new Russian federation thought there should be a multipolar world order rather than a US-centric unipolar world. The United States started sidelining Russia's role in world affairs. In this context, Russia initiated the project of multipolarity in its foreign policy strategy. The first foreign minister of the new Russian Federation, Andrei Kozyrev (1994), said that the twenty-first century would not be going to Pax Americana. Instead, multilateralism will prevail, where multiple actors will be involved in international relations. But, Russia was not so aggressive in promoting this concept back then. State representatives mentioned it on several occasions. Further, as former Russian President Boris Yeltsin (1997) argued:

> We are for a multipolar world where there is no diktat by any single country. Let the US be one pole, Russia another, Asia, Europe, and so on, still other poles. It is the base for the world to stand and ensure common security.